

culture

National Treasure

JAMMU The Society for the Promotion of Indian Classical Music and Culture Amongst Youth (SPIC-MACY), founded in 1977, has come a long way. In the early 70s, public concerts were the only window to Indian music. By arranging concerts and lecture-demonstrations at schools and colleges, SPIC-MACY provided the youth with a glimpse of Indian culture, with top rung maestros supporting the organisation with their performances.

"SPIC-MACY has taken music to unknown territories of India. If there has been an increase in the number of music listeners, the credit goes to them," says santoor maestro Pandit Shiv Kumar Sharma. "Years of hard work put in by selfless volunteers has ensured the survival and growth of Indian classical music," says Kiran Seth, national chairman, SPIC-MACY.

The programme from June 18 to 23 covers all modules like classical music, folk performances, talks by **Birju Maharaj (below left) and Pandit Kashalkar**

eminent personalities, screening of films by great film directors, yoga, crafts workshops and lecture-demonstrations.

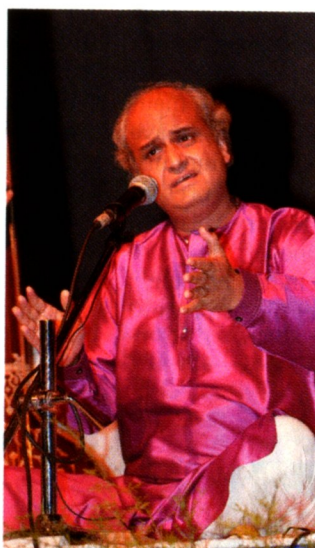
The inaugural concert will be by Parween Sultana (vocal) and Pandit Birju Maharaj (kathak). Eminent artistes at the convention include Pandit Shiv Kumar Sharma (santoor), Pandit Kishan Maharaj (tabla), Guru Raman Kutty Nair (kathakali), Guru Kalamandalam Gopi (kathakali), Dr M. Balamurali Krishna (Carnatic vocal), T. N. Krishnan (violin), Pandit Ulhas Kashalkar (vocal) and others. There will be lecture-demonstrations by painter Anjolie Ela Menon, Ustad Fahimuddin Dagar (dhrupad), J. Gurappa Chetty (kalamkari), Saswati Sen (kathak) and Purulia Chhau as well as film exhibits of directors like Satyajit Ray, Akira Kurosawa and Charlie Chaplin.

The best treat is the overnight concert on June 22 by Ustad Abdul Rahsid Khan (vocal), Shahid Parvez (sitar), T. M. Krishna (carnatic vocal) and others. Get soaked in Indian culture.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit



BANDEEP SINGH



KANISHK NEGI

theatre

Conflict Theory

BANGALORE Girish Karnad's *Flowers* is a lyrical monologue for a priest torn between his devotion to God and his carnal desire for his courtesan mistress. Body and soul have always been in conflict and have often made for great literature and Karnad uses this underlying theme for the priest's internal strife. *Flowers* is directed by Roysten Abel with Rajit Kapur essaying the role of the priest. The experimental set is designed by Abel with lights by Arghya Lahiri making it a truly visual experience. The flip side is that the rich and lyrical text does not transcend into great performance on stage, and one is left with a static and rather detached experience instead of one that is intimate and enlightening. While the premise is interesting, the soul is missing which is why the play fails to engage you in its entirety. But definitely worth a watch. At Ranga Shankara, June 15-17, 3.30 and 7.30 p.m.

by Nirmala Ravindran



Kapur as a priest torn between god and his carnal desire

art

For Christ's Sake

MUMBAI Suman Roy's current repertoire is dominated by the images of Jesus Christ in meditation defined by the colour of the space that borders Christ's face, giving it an aura and a mood. At variance with his religious background and his flamboyant character, Roy's depiction is almost like an abstraction. The background colours in wash effect create a mysti-



Roy's depiction of Christ cal impression. Roy says, "My palette differs and changes in each portrait." At Jehangir Art Gallery from June 19 to 25.

by Swati Mathur